CYBER SAFETY GUY

LIVESTREAMING

(TikTok Live, Twitch, YouTube Live): A PARENT'S PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE

Livestreaming lets people broadcast video in real time to an audience. It can be fun, creative and social – but it also comes with risks. Here's what parents need to know.

70% of 13–17 year olds have watched a live stream — Ofcom (2023)

1 IN 3 teens have livestreamed or want to — Pew Research (2022)

45% of parents worry live streaming exposes kids to inappropriate content or contact — NCSA (2023)

LIVE Anything said or shown live can be seen, saved and shared instantly

1 WHAT IT IS

Live video broadcasts in real time to an audience.

2 HOW IT WORKS

Streamers go live from an app or device. Viewers watch and interact in the chat.

3 WHAT KIDS LIKE

Real-time connection, building communities, sharing talents, gaming, Q&A, "just chatting" and being creative.

4 KEY FEATURES

Live chat, likes, donations, follows, subscriptions, hosts/raids (Twitch), gifts and reactions.

5 THE RISKS

Strangers, harmful chat, oversharing, inappropriate content, pressure to keep streaming.

6 THE CONVERSATION

Talk early. Listen often. Agree boundaries together.

WHERE KIDS MIGHT GO LIVE

TikTok LIVE
Short-form video and live. Easy to go live from mobile.

Twitch
Popular for gaming, creative and "Just Chatting" streams.

YouTube Live
Livestream on your channel to subscribers and the public.

Other Apps
Instagram Live, Kick, Facebook Live and more. Check privacy settings.

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND

1. **Live is live.** There is no edit button.
2. **Anyone can watch, message or share.** Even if accounts are private.
3. **Your child's safety comes first.** Boundaries, settings and support make a big difference.



BY THE NUMBERS

56% of teens say they watch live streams weekly — Pew Research (2022)

1 IN 4 teens have chatted with someone they don't know during a live stream — NCSA (2023)

33% of teen streamers have received unwanted invites or messages — Internet Matters (2023)

2+ HOURS the average time tweens/teens spend watching streams daily — Common Sense Media (2023)

SAFETY FEATURES / SETTINGS

WHAT EXISTS

Privacy Settings
Choose who can watch your live streams.

Chat Controls
Slow mode, subscriber-only chat, blocked words.

Moderators
Trusted people can help manage chat.

Block & Report
Block users and report abuse or inappropriate behaviour.

WHAT TO CHANGE

- Go live to Friends or Subscribers only.
- Turn on chat filters and block keywords.
- Require approval for guests/hosts.
- Review who can send gifts or donations.

Find these in: Settings > Privacy & Safety (varies by platform).

STEP-BY-STEP: STREAM SAFELY

1. **Set your goals.** Why are you streaming? What are your boundaries?
2. **Check your privacy.** Choose who can watch and comment.
3. **Set up chat controls.** Use filters, slow mode or sub-only chat.
4. **Plan your space.** Keep personal info, location and screens private.
5. **Take breaks.** Schedule offline time and step away.
6. **Review and adjust.** Check settings and what's working. Get help if needed.

THE RISKS WORTH KNOWING

Inappropriate Comments
Harmful, rude or sexual messages in chat.

Strangers & Predators
Adults may target kids in live chats.

Oversharing
Sharing too much can put safety at risk.

Pressure to Perform
Feeling pressured to stream more or accept gifts.

Scams & Exploitation
Fake giveaways, links and requests for money.

Content Going Viral
Clips can be saved and shared without consent.

THE 10-MINUTE CONVERSATION



- What do you enjoy most about going live?
- Who usually joins your chat? Anyone you don't know?
- What boundaries do you want to set?
- What should you do if something makes you uncomfortable?

TRUST OVER SURVEILLANCE
Open talks build trust. Trust keeps kids safe.

IF THINGS GO WRONG

STAY CALM & GATHER EVIDENCE

- End the stream if it feels unsafe.
- Block the user.
- Save screenshots or recordings.
- Note the time, username and what happened.

REPORT & SEEK HELP

- Report the user on the platform.
- Use in-app report tools.
- Talk to a trusted adult.
- Contact Childline if you need support.
- Get help from school if needed.

You did the right thing. Help is available.

NEED TO TALK? CHILDLINE
0800 1111
childline.org.uk
YOU ARE NOT ALONE
We're here for you.